



The One-Person Workflow

*Do the work of a
small team — as one person.*

Made for the Ones Who Move Different.

— EJOSHI —

v1.4 · ejoshi.ai

SECTION 01

THE HONEST TRUTH ABOUT SOLO WORK

Running something alone means context-switching forty times a day. Writing. Replying. Planning. Creating. Following up. Negotiating. Invoicing. Cleaning up.

AI doesn't change what you need to do. It changes how much of it you can actually get done, and how clearly you can think while doing it.

This kit is the calm version of "AI for entrepreneurs." Not the hype-soaked version that promises ten times the output. The honest version: five real roles AI can play in your work, a weekly rhythm that fits a real schedule, client communication templates for the moments that hit hardest, and a monthly audit that keeps the whole system honest.

The whole kit fits in about fifteen minutes of reading. You'll get more out of it if you set up the templates as you go, instead of reading and bookmarking. The point is one or two prompts you actually use this week.

Who this is for

- Solo founders running an early business.
- Freelancers and contractors doing client work alone.
- Side-business owners holding a day job and a project at the same time.
- Solo creators who don't have a team and aren't trying to build one.
- Anyone doing the work of five people in one calendar.

What this kit isn't

It isn't an "AI agency in a box." It isn't a workflow to scale you to ten times the revenue. It isn't a prompt list that promises to replace your team. It's a small, sustainable system that helps a single person do their actual work with less friction and clearer thinking. Honest about what AI changes, honest about what it doesn't.

The Ejoshi promise. Always honest. Built for everyone, not just the people who already know. Free to access. No paywall. No gatekeeping. The future shouldn't be locked behind a paywall.

SECTION 02

THE FIVE AI ROLES — EACH WITH A WORKED WORKFLOW

For each role: what it does, when to reach for it, and a sample prompt you can adapt today.

Role 1 — First-draft writer

What it does: takes a vague intent and gives you a starting paragraph, email, caption, or proposal. Editing a bad draft is faster than starting from a blank page.

When to use it: any time you'd otherwise stare at a blank document for ten minutes.

Workflow: context (audience, voice, goal) → ask for a first draft → edit until it sounds like you.

Sample prompt: *"I'm writing a proposal for [client] for a [project type]. My voice is direct, warm, and not corporate. Give me a first draft under 250 words covering: what I'd do, my pricing, and one concrete next step. I'll edit."*

What to keep out of it: anything confidential. Client names, financial details, anything covered by an NDA stays in your own draft. Use a fake placeholder name when working with AI on real work.

Role 2 — Research assistant

What it does: gives you a starting point on a topic, a competitor, a market, a tool, an industry term. Not a definitive source. A starting point that saves you the first hour.

When to use it: anytime you'd otherwise spend an hour Googling around in a topic you don't know yet.

Workflow: ask for the overview → ask for the three things that surprise most people → verify the surprises before you act on them.

Sample prompt: *"I'm exploring [industry/topic]. Give me a one-paragraph overview, three things most beginners get wrong, and three reputable sources I should read next."*

What to verify: every named source. AI will sometimes invent plausible-sounding citations. Check that the source exists before you cite it. Always.

Role 3 — Thinking partner

What it does: talks through a decision with you, out loud in text. Doesn't decide. Helps you see what you're missing.

When to use it: anytime you've been chewing on a decision for more than a day.

Workflow: dump everything you know → ask for what you might be missing → ask it to challenge your assumptions.

Sample prompt: *"I'm deciding whether to [decision]. Here's everything I know: [situation, options, pros, cons, my gut]. What am I underweighting? What's a question I haven't asked? Argue against my current leaning."*

What to expect: not a recommendation. A sharper view of your own thinking. The output is the structure, not the answer.

Role 4 — Template machine

What it does: builds you a strong template once, then produces variations of it endlessly. One great cold email becomes fifty client-specific cold emails. One sales page becomes ten audience-specific sales pages.

When to use it: anytime you find yourself writing the same kind of thing for the third time in a week.

Workflow: write the strong template by hand → give it to AI with the variables → ask for one example of how it would adapt for [specific situation].

Sample prompt: *"Here's my template: [paste]. The variables are [list]. Show me how this would adapt for a [specific client/scenario]. Keep the structure; change only what would actually differ."*

What you keep ownership of: the template itself. AI is good at variations. You're the one who knows what the strong original needs to look like.

Role 5 — Client communications

What it does: drafts difficult emails — late delivery, scope creep, hard no, follow-up after silence, raising a rate. Anything where the words matter and the stakes feel personal.

When to use it: anytime you're avoiding sending a message because the words are stuck.

Workflow: describe the situation honestly → name the emotion you're feeling → ask for a draft that's direct and respectful, not soft, not angry.

Sample prompt: *"I need to write to my client about [situation]. Here's my read: [honest version]. Here's how I'm feeling: [emotion]. Help me write a three-paragraph email that's direct and respectful — not soft, not angry. End with what I'm asking for."*

What you decide: whether to send. The first AI draft is rarely sendable. Edit until it sounds like you. Then send.

The pattern. Five roles. Each one removes a specific kind of friction. None of them replace your judgment. The whole point is to clear the table so your judgment has room to show up.

SECTION 03

THE WEEKLY AI RHYTHM

A schedule you can actually keep. Ninety minutes total per week, spread across three slots. Nothing daily that requires willpower.

Monday morning · 20 minutes

The week-planning prompt. Paste your week's priorities into AI. Ask:

"Here are my top six things this week: [list]. What am I not accounting for? What's the highest-leverage use of my time this week if I can only do three of them well?"

What this does: surfaces what you're missing. Not what to do — you already know that. What you forgot to weigh in.

Daily writing · as needed (5-15 min per use)

First drafts always go to AI before they go to you. Save your edit-time for editing, not generating.

"Write a [type of message] to [audience] about [topic]. My voice is [describe]. Keep it under [length]. No jargon."

What this does: cuts your writing time roughly in half on the things you do all the time. Email, captions, follow-ups, intros.

Friday review · 15 minutes

The weekly shipment summary. Paste what you got done. Ask:

"Here's what I shipped this week: [list]. Write a one-paragraph summary I could use in a newsletter, a portfolio update, or a case study. Direct. No fluff."

What this does: builds a running log of what you actually did. You'll want this for newsletters, portfolios, year-end reviews, and the times you forget how much you got done.

Why this rhythm

It's three blocks. Ninety minutes total. It works on weeks when everything is on fire and on weeks when nothing is. The whole point is sustainability — most "AI productivity systems" fail because they assume you'll do them every day. This one assumes you won't, and still works.

The optional fourth slot — Wednesday clean-up

If you have an extra twenty minutes mid-week, ask AI to help you triage your inbox: *"Here are the 30 unread emails I've been avoiding: [paste subject lines + senders]. Sort them: needs reply this week / can wait two weeks / can be a one-line yes-or-no / safe to archive."* This isn't AI doing your inbox. It's AI giving you a sorted list you can blow through in twenty minutes instead of an hour.

SECTION 04

CLIENT COMMUNICATION TEMPLATES BY SCENARIO

Five scenarios you'll hit if you do client work long enough. For each: when to use it, and the prompt that gets you a usable first draft.

Scenario 1 — The late-delivery email

You're going to miss a deadline. You need to tell them before they ask.

Prompt: *"I'm going to miss the [date] deadline on [project] by [time]. The reason is [honest reason]. Help me write a short email that owns it without over-apologizing, gives a new realistic date, and offers one concrete thing I'll do to make up for it."*

Scenario 2 — The scope-creep email

The project has quietly grown. You need to name it without making it a conflict.

Prompt: *"My client has added [list of new requests] to the project we originally agreed was [original scope]. I want to acknowledge the new requests, name that they're outside the original scope, and propose either an additional fee or a revised timeline — without it sounding combative."*

Scenario 3 — The hard no

You have to decline. They want you to do something you can't or won't.

Prompt: *"I need to decline [request] from [client]. The reason I can't do it is [honest reason]. Help me write a short response that's clear, kind, doesn't over-explain, and leaves the door open for future work on different terms."*

Scenario 4 — The follow-up after silence

You sent a proposal. They went quiet. It's been over a week.

Prompt: *"I sent a proposal to [client] [number of days] ago about [project]. I haven't heard back. Write a short, low-pressure follow-up that doesn't sound needy, references one specific thing from our earlier conversation, and gives them an easy out if they've decided not to move forward."*

Scenario 5 — The rate-raise message

You're raising prices. You need to tell existing clients.

Prompt: *"I'm raising my rate from [old] to [new] starting [date]. I want to write a short message to existing clients that explains the change is reasonable, gives them a grace period at the old rate, and isn't apologetic."*

Treat them like adults."

Scenario 6 — The breakup email

The client relationship isn't working. You need to end it cleanly.

Prompt: *"I'm ending my work with [client]. The reason is [honest reason — fit, scope, payment, values].*

Write a short, professional message that closes the relationship cleanly, hands off any work in progress, and doesn't burn the bridge. No apology. No explanation beyond what's necessary."

What these have in common. Each one names a real situation, gives the AI the specifics it needs, and tells the AI what NOT to do (too soft, too apologetic, combative). The negative instructions are doing the most work. AI defaults to sycophantic; constraint pulls it back to professional.

SECTION 05

THE MONTHLY AI AUDIT

Once a month. Fifteen minutes. Four questions.

1. *What did AI save me this month?* (in concrete time) 2. *Where did AI waste my time this month?* (a prompt that didn't land, a feature that overpromised) 3. *What's one new thing I could try with AI next month?* 4. *Is there a place in my work where I'm reaching for AI when I shouldn't — automating something that's actually the heart of the work?*

That fourth question is the most important. Solo operators using AI well drift toward letting it touch the parts of the business that should stay theirs — the voice, the taste, the relationships, the judgment calls. The monthly audit catches that drift while it's still small.

Write the answers down somewhere. Not for anyone else. For future you, to compare against the answers you'll write in three months.

SECTION 06

WHAT AI CANNOT DO FOR YOU

The honest list. None of these are because AI is "bad" — they're because AI is the wrong shape for the job.

- **It can't build your relationships.** Trust between you and a client is built through specific things you remembered, follow-through under pressure, and the way you handled the moments that mattered. AI can draft a message; it can't be there.
- **It can't develop your taste.** What makes your work yours is your taste — the things you would never let through, the things you specifically reach for. AI flattens taste toward the average. Don't outsource taste.
- **It can't make the judgment calls.** Should you take this client? Lower your rate? Walk away from a project? Those calls come from knowing your specific situation, industry, and values. AI can lay out trade-offs. It can't decide.
- **It can't replace the thinking.** AI is great at clearing the table so you can think. The thinking is still yours. Solo operators who use AI to skip the thinking find themselves three months in with a business that doesn't quite work and they can't figure out why.

The frame. AI is a power tool, not a partner. Power tools work because you bring the judgment. The day you outsource the judgment is the day the work stops being yours.

SECTION 07

THE QUIET COMPOUND

Solo work compounds quietly. You don't see the result of any single week. You see it in the gap between where you were six months ago and where you are now.

AI changes that compound rate. Not dramatically. By a few percent, week over week. Five extra emails sent on time. Three first drafts you didn't get stuck on. Two decisions you got unstuck on. One difficult message that didn't sit in your drafts folder for three days.

Multiply that by a year of weeks. The difference shows up.

You don't have to be an AI power user. You don't have to use it every day. You just have to use it on the right things — the things where AI is genuinely good and you're genuinely stuck — and trust the compound to do its work.

What to track

Once you've used AI for a month, try this: in your monthly audit, note the things AI saved you on. After three months, you'll see a pattern. The kinds of work that AI is genuinely good at FOR YOU — given your specific business, your specific clients, your specific writing voice — will surface. That list is more valuable than any general guide, including this one. It's your customized AI manual, calibrated to the work you actually do.

Start with one role. Save the prompts that worked. Come back when you need them.

— Ejoshi ejoshi.ai